NORTHGATE RESIDENCE — STUDENT HOSTEL HANDBOOK

Fictional training document for a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) assignment
Policy version: 3.2
Effective date: 1 July 2026
Applies to: Residents of Northgate Residence, a fictional college hostel
Issued by: Northgate Residence Office

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This handbook describes the local rules, dates, fees, processes, and facilities for Northgate Residence. The figures and rules in this document are fictional and are provided only for coursework practice. They do not apply to any real college or hostel.

OFFICE CONTACT AND HOURS

The Residence Office is located in Block A, Room A-014. It is open Monday to Friday from 09:00 to 16:30, and Saturday from 09:00 to 12:00. The office is closed on Sundays and public holidays. Residents should submit non-urgent forms during office hours. For urgent safety issues outside office hours, residents should contact the duty warden at the number displayed on the noticeboard beside the main entrance.

RESIDENCE CAPACITY

Northgate Residence has 120 rooms across three residential blocks: Block A has 40 rooms, Block B has 44 rooms, and Block C has 36 rooms. Each room is assigned to two residents, except six accessible rooms in Block A that are assigned to one resident each. Room changes require written approval from the Residence Office; verbal permission from another resident is not sufficient.

1. ADMISSION AND CHECK-IN

ELIGIBILITY AND DOCUMENTS

A student offered a hostel place must complete check-in in person. The student must present a college identity card, one government-issued photo identification document, the admission confirmation, and one recent passport-size photograph. A resident who has not completed check-in may not collect a room key.

CHECK-IN DATES

For the 2026–2027 academic year, standard check-in runs from 20 July 2026 through 25 July 2026, between 08:30 and 17:00. A resident who expects to arrive after 17:00 must email the Residence Office by 15:00 on the same day. Late arrivals are handled by the duty warden only after the office has recorded the student's request.

SECURITY DEPOSIT

The refundable security deposit is ■4,000 per resident. It must be paid before a room key is issued. The deposit is returned after checkout, subject to deductions for unpaid charges, missing keys, or damage beyond ordinary wear. Refund processing normally takes 15 working days after the final room inspection.

ROOM ALLOCATION

Room allocation is made by the Residence Office based on availability and accessibility requirements. Residents may not exchange keys or occupy an unassigned bed. Requests for a room change must use Form NR-04 and include a reason. The office aims to respond within three working days, but a request is not approved until written confirmation is issued.

2. FEES AND PAYMENTS

HOSTEL FEES

The monthly accommodation fee for the 2026–2027 academic year is ■6,800 per resident. The monthly dining plan is ■3,200 and is billed separately. Both charges are due on or before the fifth calendar day of each month.

LATE PAYMENT

A late payment charge of ■150 is added if the accommodation fee remains unpaid after the tenth calendar day of the month. A separate ■100 charge applies to a dining-plan payment that remains unpaid after the tenth calendar day. The charges are applied once per overdue monthly bill, not once per day.

PAYMENT METHODS

Residents may pay through the college payment portal or at the accounts counter in Administration Block, Room G-006. Cash payments are not accepted at the Residence Office. Residents should keep the electronic receipt or stamped counter receipt until the payment appears in their student account.

FEE DISPUTES

A resident who believes a charge is incorrect must submit Form NR-07 with a copy of the receipt within seven calendar days of the charge appearing in the student account. The Accounts Team acknowledges a complete dispute within two working days and aims to resolve it within ten working days. Submitting a dispute does not automatically pause the due date; the Accounts Team must confirm any hold in writing.

3. ATTENDANCE, ENTRY AND QUIET HOURS

MAIN GATE

The main gate is open from 05:30 to 22:00. Residents returning after 22:00 must use the staffed side entrance, show their college identity card, and enter their arrival time in the late-entry register. Visitors are not permitted to enter after 20:00.

QUIET HOURS

Quiet hours apply every day from 22:00 to 06:00. During this period, residents must keep conversations, music, calls, and other noise at a level that does not disturb nearby rooms. Repeated complaints may result in a written warning and a meeting with the warden.

OVERNIGHT ABSENCE

A resident planning to stay away overnight must submit Form NR-02 through the residence portal before 20:00 on the day of departure. The form must include the expected return date, destination, and an emergency contact number. If an unexpected emergency prevents advance submission, the resident or their guardian must inform the duty warden as soon as reasonably possible.

VISITORS

Visitors must register at the gate, show photo identification, and be accompanied by the resident they are visiting. Visitors may remain in the common lounge until 20:00 but may not enter sleeping rooms. Residents are responsible for ensuring their visitors follow hostel rules. A visitor who refuses a safety instruction may be asked to leave.

4. FACILITIES, MAINTENANCE AND SAFETY

DINING HALL

Breakfast is served from 07:00 to 09:00, lunch from 12:30 to 14:30, and dinner from 19:00 to 21:00. The dining hall is closed from 14:30 to 19:00 except for cleaning and scheduled maintenance. Residents with a documented food allergy should submit Form NR-09 to the dining supervisor.

LAUNDRY

Laundry rooms are located on the ground floor of Blocks B and C. The laundry room opens from 06:00 to 22:00. Each wash cycle costs ■40 and each dryer cycle costs ■30. Residents should remove clothes within 15 minutes after a cycle ends. Items left unattended for more than 24 hours may be moved to the labelled lost-property shelf.

MAINTENANCE REQUESTS

Residents should report plumbing, electrical, furniture, or internet problems using Form NR-11 in the residence portal. The request must include the room number, a short description, and a photo when practical. Routine requests are normally inspected within two working days. Electrical sparks, smoke, gas smell, or active flooding must be reported immediately to the duty warden rather than submitted as a routine request.

FIRE AND EMERGENCY SAFETY

Fire exits and corridors must remain unobstructed. Cooking appliances with exposed heating elements, candles, and open flames are prohibited inside resident rooms. During a fire alarm, residents must leave by the nearest safe exit and assemble at the marked courtyard point. Residents must not re-enter until the fire safety officer gives permission.

5. CHECKOUT, DISCIPLINE AND QUICK REFERENCE

CHECKOUT

A resident leaving the hostel permanently must submit Form NR-15 at least three calendar days before the intended checkout date. Before leaving, the resident must return the room key, clear personal belongings, settle outstanding bills, and complete a room inspection with a residence staff member. The inspection records existing damage and missing items. The resident should provide bank details through the secure student portal for the deposit refund; bank details must not be sent by ordinary email.

DAMAGE AND LOST KEYS

A replacement room key costs ■250. Damage charges depend on the repair or replacement cost documented by the Residence Office. Residents may request a copy of the inspection record within five working days. Ordinary wear, such as normal fading from use, is not treated as damage.

DISCIPLINARY PROCESS

For a first non-safety-related minor breach, the warden may issue a verbal reminder and record the date. A repeated breach may result in a written warning. Serious safety risks, violence, deliberate property damage, or tampering with fire equipment may be referred directly to the Hostel Discipline Committee. A resident will be given an opportunity to provide a written response within three working days after receiving a written notice. The handbook does not specify an automatic fine for every rule breach.

QUICK REFERENCE

- Security deposit: ■4,000 per resident.
- Monthly accommodation fee: ■6,800, due by the fifth calendar day.
- Monthly dining plan: ■3,200, billed separately.
- Late accommodation payment charge: ■150 after the tenth calendar day.
- Late dining-plan payment charge: ■100 after the tenth calendar day.
- Replacement room key: ■250.
- Standard check-in: 20–25 July 2026, 08:30–17:00.
- Quiet hours: 22:00–06:00 daily.
- Overnight absence form: NR-02, submit before 20:00.
- Routine maintenance: Form NR-11; inspection normally within two working days.

END OF HANDBOOK

This fictional handbook is a practice source for the accompanying RAG notebook. If a question asks about a rule not stated here, the correct response is that the document does not provide that information.